

# Navigating Screen Time Limitations



Image courtesy :  
<https://www.spd.org.sg/>

## TIME LIMITATIONS

### HELPFUL TIPS

"Here are some tips for parents to help their children improve their screen time habits"

by implementing these strategies, parents can help their children develop healthy screen time habits and balance their use of screens with other activities. It is important to be consistent and to model healthy behaviors yourself, as children often learn by example.



1. **SET LIMITS:** Establish clear rules for screen time, such as limits on the amount of time spent on screens and when screens can be used. Make sure to communicate these rules clearly and consistently, and to enforce them.

2. **MONITOR CONTENT:** Be aware of the content your child is accessing on screens, and ensure that it is appropriate for their age and development. Consider using parental controls or monitoring software to help with this.



3. **ENCOURAGE ALTERNATIVE ACTIVITIES:** Encourage your child to engage in other activities besides screens, such as outdoor play, reading, or socializing. Make sure to provide opportunities for these activities and to model healthy screen time habits yourself.

4. **BE PRESENT:** When your child is using screens, be present and engaged with them. Ask them about what they are doing or watching, and use it as an opportunity to discuss their interests and values.



## TIME LIMITATIONS



5. **BE A ROLE MODEL:** Parents play a vital role in being positive role models for their children when it comes to healthy screen time. They can achieve this by turning off app notifications to avoid constant distractions, keeping their phones on silent while picking up their kids, enforcing a no-phone/TV rule during study time, replacing screen time with interactive activities, and involving their children in kitchen tasks like setting the table, cooking, and cleaning up.

6. **CREATE SCREEN-FREE ZONES:** Establish areas or times in your home that are designated as screen-free zones, such as meal times or bedrooms. This can help promote healthy habits and limit excessive screen time.



7. **HAVE OPEN COMMUNICATION:** Talk to your child about their screen time habits and listen to their concerns or questions. Use it as an opportunity to teach them about responsible screen time use and to model healthy behaviors yourself.



"Here are some activities that parents can use to enhance their children's screen time:"

## TIME LIMITATIONS

HELPFUL  
ACTIONS



By using these activities, parents can enhance their children's screen time and promote learning, creativity, and healthy habits. It is important to balance screen time with other activities and to monitor content to ensure that it is appropriate for your child's age and development.

1. **EDUCATIONAL APPS:** There are many educational apps available that can help children learn new skills and reinforce their knowledge in subjects like math, reading, science, and more.



2. **CREATIVE APPS:** Encourage your child's creativity with apps that allow them to create and express themselves, such as drawing, painting, or music apps.

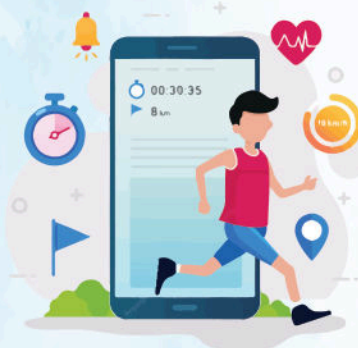
3. **CO-VIEWING:** Watch videos or shows with your child and use it as an opportunity to talk about what you are watching and to ask questions. This can help promote engagement and learning.



4. **VIRTUAL TOURS:** Take virtual tours of museums, historical sites, or other places of interest with your child. This can be a fun and educational way to explore new places and learn about different cultures.

## TIME LIMITATIONS

5. **ONLINE GAMES:** Many online games can be both entertaining and educational, as they can help children develop problem-solving skills and cognitive abilities.



6. **EXERCISE APPS:** Use apps that encourage physical activity and exercise, such as dance games or yoga apps. This can help balance out sedentary screen time with physical activity.



7. **VIDEO CALLS:** Use video calls to stay connected with family and friends, and to promote socialization and communication skills.

## TIME LIMITATIONS

### SOME MORE PRACTICAL TIPS



**CHILD:** Music helps me sleep, why can't I listen to music on my phone?

**PARENT:** I understand that music helps you sleep. How about we get you a radio with earphones? It will provide a similar soothing effect without the distractions of a phone.

**CHILD:** I need to read books on my iPad.

**PARENT:** I appreciate your love for reading. Let's explore the local library together and find physical books that you can enjoy.

**CHILD:** I need an alarm clock to wake up.

**PARENT:** That's a responsible approach. Let's go shopping for an alarm clock that can help you wake up on time and reduce the need for your phone in the bedroom.

**CHILD:** All of my friends have their tablets or phones in their bedrooms... I'm the only one who's not allowed!

## Q TIME LIMITATIONS

**PARENT:** "Every family has different rules and priorities. In our home, we believe it's important to have designated screen-free spaces. It helps us focus on other activities and promotes better sleep."

**CHILD:** "You used to let me have my phone in my room when I was sleeping. Why not now?"

**PARENT:** "As a parent, I continuously learn and adapt my approach. Based on new information and research, I've realized the potential risks of excessive technology use. That's why we've made adjustments to our rules."

**CHILD:** "I'll miss out on everything my friends are doing if I don't stay connected!"

**PARENT:** "I understand the fear of missing out, but it's important to find a balance. Being present in the moment and engaging in offline activities enriches our lives in different ways. We can still stay connected while also enjoying other experiences."

**CHILD:** "My friends are upset. I have to keep talking with them!"

**PARENT:** "I understand that maintaining friendships is important to you. However, it's crucial to prioritize your overall well-being. Excessive screen time can impact your sleep, focus, and responsibilities. Let's find a balance that works for everyone."

**CHILD:** "Just a bit more time! I'm winning the game and can't stop now or I'll lose all my points!"

**PARENT:** "I appreciate your dedication, but it's essential to honor the agreed-upon time limits. If you're unable to stop playing when we agreed, there will be consequences, such as a reduction in screen time tomorrow. It's important to develop self-discipline and manage our time effectively."